

TWS IN-EAR EARPHONES



Sounds good?* Don't buy it.

**the marketing jargon*

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India has seen exponential growth in the TWS space across all budgets. With the budget market being flooded by offerings from brands like Boult Audio, boAt, Dizo, realme, Anker, and the like, we are seeing brands like Nothing, OnePlus, Sony, Samsung, and Bose, and others locking horns in the mid-range and premium price brackets. For the consumers, there is a problem of plenty. Picking the best TWS in-ear earphones in every price bucket takes a lot of consideration from the consumer, with different offerings bringing different sets of features to the table with varying levels of efficacy.

So, to help you make the right choice when it comes to spending your hard-earned cash, I did some digging around across budgets and curated a list of the best offerings across budgets, and what you should look out for, when buying TWS in-ear earphones. The budget categories are - under 5K (budget), between 5K and 10K (mid-range), and above 10K (premium).

Note: The pricing of the in-ear earphones that will be considered in this article would be the average lowest price of that earbud on popular e-commerce platforms in the last 2-3 months. That is

the best price to get the in-ear earphones, as per the research done by the author.

Before going in, as I have said in my reviews for some time now, audio as a category is very subjective. We can give you indicative data about the sound profile of a pair of TWS in-ear earphones, but they might perform differently compared to what we tested, given the shape of your ear. Many brands, in the premium and mid-range budget segments, address this issue with features like personalised tuning and ear mapping enabled by the accompanying software; it remains something that should be kept in mind when purchasing a pair of TWS in-ear earphones. Additionally, personal preferences, such as the genre of music that you listen to, do play an important role. Even things like fit of the in-ear earphones can affect their sound quality, so keep that in mind when purchasing TWS in-ear earphones.

With that said, let's have a look at the features and expected sound signature that you should look for when purchasing TWS in-ear earphones in India across budget categories –

BUDGET TWS (UNDER ₹5,000)

When you are looking at purchasing

budget TWS in-ear earphones, you are expected to lose out on a number of creature comforts that you would get with more expensive in-ear earphones. However, increased competition amongst brands has ensured that you can get a taste of features like ANC, well-implemented low latency mode, Hi-Res audio, customisation via a companion app, wireless charging and the like, if you are willing to push your budget slightly the top end of this segment.

With the expectations set right, let's have a look at the features that you should look at and expect when looking to buy a pair of budget TWS in-ear earphones –

Environmental Noise Cancelling:

This is not to be confused with Active Noise Cancellation; ENC uses AI and ML to ensure that you get clear sound during calls. You can find this feature implemented in TWS in-ear earphones across all price points in this budget segment.

Quick Switch and Multi-point connectivity: If you are someone who is working across multiple devices, then having multi-point connectivity and quick switch is a great feature. Earlier, it was usually found in earphones on the pricier side, but it has made its way into earphones in the budget categories as well. Certain TWS earphones might